



Torres Strait Fisheries (Prawn) Management Instrument 2025

The Protected Zone Joint Authority make the following instrument.

Dated 19 December 2025

The Hon Julie Collins MP, Commonwealth Minister for Agriculture, Fisheries and Forestry

The Hon Anthony (Tony) Perrett MP, Queensland Minister for Primary Industries

Mr George Nona, Chairperson, Torres Strait Regional Authority

For and on behalf of the Protected Zone Joint Authority

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1 Name

This instrument is the *Torres Strait Fisheries (Prawn) Management Instrument 2025*.

2 Commencement

This instrument commences on the day after it is registered on the Federal Register of Legislation.

3 Authority

This instrument is made under section 16(1) and section 35(1)(a) of the Act.

4 Definitions

Note: A number of expressions used in this instrument are defined in section 3 of the Act, including the following:

- (a) boat;
- (b) fish;
- (c) Torres Strait Treaty;
- (d) traditional inhabitant;
- (e) traditional fishing;
- (f) Treaty endorsement.

In this instrument:

Act means the *Torres Strait Fisheries Act 1984*.

anchorage zones means the areas described in Schedule 2.

closed areas, known as East of Warrior Reef Closed Areas, means the areas described in Schedule 1.

closure period means the period commencing at 1700 hours local time on 1 February in a year and ending at 1700 hours local time on 31 July in the same year.

exclusion zones means the area described in Part 2 of Schedule 1 of the Management Plan.

fishery means the Torres Strait Prawn Fishery as described in the Management Plan.

fishing day means fishing day as defined in section 1.3(1) of the Management Plan.

fishing season means the period determined under section 2.3 of the Management Plan.

local time means the time of day in the State of Queensland.

Management Plan means the management plan determined by the PZJA under section 15A and section 35(1)(a) of the Act in relation to the fishery as may be in

force from time to time, currently entitled the *Torres Strait Prawn Fishery Management Plan 2009*

Moreton Bay bugs means fish of the genus *Thenus spp.*

prawns means all species of fish that are listed in Parts 1 and 2 of Schedule 3 of the Management Plan, including Moreton Bay bugs.

prawn fishery means the area described in Part 1 of Schedule 1 of the Management Plan, excluding the area described in Part 2 of Schedule 1 of the Management Plan.

prawn licensed person means a person who has been granted a licence under subsection 19(1), 19(2) or 19(3) of the Act that authorises the taking, processing or carrying of prawns in the area of the prawn fishery.

prawn trawling equipment means otter trawl equipment as specified in Schedule 3.

5 Schedules

Each instrument that is specified in a Schedule to this instrument is amended or repealed as set out in the applicable items in the Schedule concerned, and any other item in a Schedule to this instrument has effect according to its terms.

6 Description of closed areas and anchorage zones

- (1) The position of a geographical coordinate for the description of the closed areas in Part 1 of Schedule 1 is to be determined by reference to the Australian Geodetic Datum 1966 (AGD66).
- (2) For convenience in the use of navigational aids, the closed areas are also described in Part 2 of Schedule 1 by reference to the World Geodetic Datum 1984 (WGS84).
- (3) If there is any inconsistency between the coordinates in Part 1 of Schedule 1 and Part 2 of Schedule 1, then Part 1 of Schedule 1 takes precedence to the extent of the inconsistency.
- (4) The position of a geographical coordinate in the description of the area of the anchorage zones in Schedule 2 is to be determined by reference to the World Geodetic Datum 1984 (WGS84).

7 Prohibition on the taking, processing or carrying of prawns

- (1) The taking of prawns in the area of the prawn fishery is prohibited.
- (2) The taking of prawns in the area of the closed areas is prohibited.
- (3) The taking of prawns in the area of the exclusion zones is prohibited.
- (4) The processing, or carrying of prawns in the area of the prawn fishery and exclusion zones is prohibited.

8 Exemptions to the prohibitions

- (1) A person is exempt from the prohibition in subsection 7(1) where:
- (a) The person is a prawn licensed person; and
 - (b) The person holds unused fishing days; and
 - (c) The person takes prawns only during a fishing season.
- (2) A person is exempt from the prohibition in subsection 7(2) where:
- (a) The person is a prawn licensed person; and
 - (b) The person holds unused fishing days and
 - (c) The person takes prawns only during a fishing season, and not during a closure period .
- (3) For the purposes of subsections 1(b) and 2(b), a prawn licensed person is taken to have used a fishing day where the boat nominated to the licence held by the person is:
- (a) in the area of the prawn fishery; and
 - (b) is not within the area of an anchorage zone; and
 - (c) at any time between 1800 hours local time on one day and 0600 hours local time on the next day:
 - i. the boat has moved at a speed of less than 5 knots; and
 - ii. has moved more than 250 metres; or
 - (d) the boats position has not been reported and an exemption to report has not been granted by AFMA.
- (4) A person is exempt from the prohibition in subsection 7(4) where:
- (a) the person is a prawn licensed person; and
 - (b) the person processes, or carries prawns during the period commencing at 1700 hours local time on 1 February in a year and ending at 0600 hours local time on 15 December in that same year.

9 Treaty endorsements

A person is exempt from subsections 7(1), 7(2) and 7(4) where:

- (a) he or she takes, processes or carries prawns on a boat for which a Treaty endorsement is in force; and
- (b) the person takes, processes or carries prawns only during a fishing season; and

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- (c) the person does not take, process or carry prawns in the closed area during a closure period; and
 - (d) the prawns are taken, processed or carried in accordance with conditions specified in the Treaty endorsement under section 22 of the Act.

10 Prohibition on the use of certain equipment

- (1) The taking of prawns in the area of the prawn fishery using equipment to which subsection (2) applies is prohibited.
- (2) This subsection applies to all fishing equipment other than prawn trawling equipment.

11 Prohibition on possession or control of certain equipment

- (1) A person, other than a prawn licensed person or a person who satisfies subsections 9(a) to (d) inclusive, is prohibited from having in his or her possession or under his or her control, on a boat, any quantity of equipment capable of taking prawns, in the area of the prawn fishery.
- (2) Subsection (1) applies to all equipment capable of taking prawns unless the equipment is carried so that all of the equipment is out of the water.
- (3) All persons are prohibited from having in his or her possession or under his or her control, on a boat, any quantity of equipment capable of taking prawns, in the area of the closed areas during a closure period and in the area of exclusion zones.
- (4) Subsection (3) applies to all equipment capable of taking prawns unless the equipment is carried so that all of the equipment is out of the water.

12 Prohibition on taking, processing or carrying of Moreton Bay bugs

- (1) The taking, processing or carrying of Moreton Bay bugs in the area of the prawn fishery is prohibited.
- (2) A person is exempt from subsection (1) when the person is a prawn licensed person.
- (3) The taking, processing or carrying of Moreton Bay bugs by a prawn licensed person is prohibited where, measured at the widest point of the carapace, the carapace is less than 75 millimetres.

Schedule 1—Closed areas

NOTES:

- (1) The position of a geographical coordinate in the description of the closed areas East of Warrior Reef are to be determined by reference to the Australian Geodetic Datum 1966 (AGD66), that is to say, by reference to a spheroid having its centre at the centre of the Earth and a major (equatorial) radius of 6,378,160 metres and a flattening of 1/298.25 and the position of the Johnston Geodetic Station in the Northern Territory of Australia. That station is to be taken to be situated at Latitude 25°56'54.5515" South and at Longitude 133°12'30.0771" East and to have a ground level of 571.2 metres above the spheroid referred to above.
- (2) For convenience, the coordinates of the closed areas East of Warrior Reef are also expressed in Part 2 of this Schedule based on the World Geodetic Datum 1984 (WGS84) Reference Frame at the 2005.0 epoch. The geographic coordinates are referenced to the WGS84 reference spheroid having its centre at the centre of the Earth and a major (equatorial) radius of 6,378,137 metres and a flattening of 1/298.257223563.
- (3) In the case of an inconsistency between the coordinates in Part 1 of Schedule 1 and Part 2 of Schedule 1, Part 1 of Schedule 1 takes precedence to the extent of the inconsistency – see section 6.

PART 1

The area bounded by a line:

Reference	Description
(1)	commencing at the point of Latitude 10° 00' 00" South, Longitude 142° 56' 28" East;
(2)	thence east along that parallel to its intersection by the meridian of Longitude 143° 04' 24" East;
(3)	thence north-easterly along the geodesic to the point of Latitude 9° 52' 30" South, Longitude 143° 09' 30" East;
(4)	thence north-easterly along the geodesic to the point of Latitude 9° 46' 00" South, Longitude 143° 14' 00" East;
(5)	thence north-easterly along the geodesic to the point of, Latitude 9° 36' 30" South, Longitude 143° 17' 00" East;
(6)	thence north-easterly along the geodesic to the point of Latitude 9° 33' 00" South, Longitude 143° 20' 00" East;
(7)	thence west along that parallel to its intersection by the meridian of Longitude 143° 19' 46" East;
(8)	thence along a series of intersecting arcs of circles having a radius of three miles and drawn successively from the following points, - (which describe that part of the territorial sea of Pearce Cay which lies North of the Fisheries Jurisdiction Line) –

REFERENCE	LATITUDE (AGD66)	LONGITUDE (AGD66)
8(a)	9° 30' 50"S	143° 17' 40"E
8(b)	9° 30' 48"S	143° 17' 42"E
8(c)	9° 30' 41"S	143° 17' 43"E
8(d)	9° 30' 42"S	143° 17' 34"E
8(e)	9° 30' 43"S	143° 17' 26"E
8(f)	9° 30' 46"S	143° 17' 19"E
8(g)	9° 30' 50"S	143° 17' 08"E
8(h)	9° 30' 53"S	143° 17' 03"E
8(i)	9° 30' 56"S	143° 17' 03"E
8(j)	to the point of Latitude 9° 33' 00" South, Longitude 143° 14' 51" East;	
(9)	thence west along that parallel to its intersection by the meridian of Longitude 143° 11' 00" East;	
(10)	thence south-westerly along the geodesic to the point of Latitude 9° 46' 00" South, Longitude 143° 02' 20" East;	
(11)	thence south-westerly along the geodesic to the point of commencement.	

PART 2

East of Warrior Reef Closed Areas Expressed Using Coordinates Based on WGS84

REFERENCE	LATITUDE (WGS84)	LONGITUDE (WGS84)
1	9° 59' 54.66" S	142° 56' 31.93" E
2	9° 59' 54.66" S	143° 04' 27.93" E
3	9° 52' 24.66" S	143° 09' 33.92" E
4	9° 45' 54.66" S	143° 14' 03.92" E
5	9° 36' 24.66" S	143° 17' 03.92" E
6	9° 32' 54.67" S	143° 20' 03.91" E
7	9° 32' 54.67" S	143° 19' 49.91" E
8(a)	9° 30' 44.67" S	143° 17' 43.91" E
8(b)	9° 30' 42.67" S	143° 17' 45.91" E
8(c)	9° 30' 35.67" S	143° 17' 46.91" E
8(d)	9° 30' 36.67" S	143° 17' 37.91" E
8(e)	9° 30' 37.67" S	143° 17' 29.91" E
8(f)	9° 30' 40.67" S	143° 17' 22.91" E
8(g)	9° 30' 44.67" S	143° 17' 11.91" E
8(h)	9° 30' 47.67" S	143° 17' 06.91" E
8(i)	9° 30' 50.67" S	143° 17' 06.91" E
8(j)	9° 32' 54.67" S	143° 14' 54.92" E
9	9° 32' 54.67" S	143° 11' 03.92" E
10	9° 45' 54.66" S	143° 02' 23.93" E
11	9° 59' 54.66" S	142° 56' 31.93" E

Schedule 2—Anchorage zones

AUREED ISLAND

That area of waters bounded by a line:

- (1) commencing at the point of intersection of the parallel of Latitude 9° 55' 59.10" South and the meridian of Longitude 143° 18' 56.10" East;
- (2) running thence south-easterly along the geodesic to the point of Latitude 9° 57' 18.54" South, Longitude 143° 19' 22.38" East;
- (3) thence south-westerly along the geodesic to the point of Latitude 9° 58' 47.22" South, Longitude 143° 18' 02.28" East;
- (4) thence west along the geodesic to the point of Latitude 9° 58' 31.02" South, Longitude 143° 15' 52.92" East;
- (5) thence north along the geodesic to the point of Latitude 9° 57' 28.32" South, Longitude 143° 15' 51.24" East;
- (6) thence north-easterly along the geodesic to the point of Latitude 9° 56' 00.18" South, Longitude 143° 17' 10.08" East;
- (7) thence easterly along the meridian to the point of commencement where it terminates.

YORKE ISLAND

That area of waters bounded by a line:

- (1) commencing at the point of intersection of the parallel of Latitude 9° 43' 11.82" South and the meridian of Longitude 143° 27' 38.82" East;
- (2) running thence south-easterly along the geodesic to the point of Latitude 9° 43' 47.04" South, Longitude 143° 28' 01.86" East;
- (3) thence south along the geodesic to the point of Latitude 9° 44' 42.72" South, Longitude 143° 28' 04.38" East;
- (4) thence south-westerly along the geodesic to the point of Latitude 9° 45' 27.48" South, Longitude 143° 27' 35.22" East;
- (5) thence south-westerly along the geodesic to the point of Latitude 9° 45' 51.18" South, Longitude 143° 26' 45.42" East;
- (6) thence south-westerly along the geodesic to the point of Latitude 9° 46' 02.34" South, Longitude 143° 25' 43.68" East;
- (7) thence south-westerly along the geodesic to the point of Latitude 9° 46' 21.42" South, Longitude 143° 24' 33.30" East;
- (8) thence north-westerly along the geodesic to the point of Latitude 9° 46' 05.88" South, Longitude 143° 23' 49.68" East;

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- (9) thence north-westerly along the geodesic to the point of Latitude 9° 45' 22.80" South, Longitude 143° 23' 25.86" East;
 - (10) thence north-easterly along the geodesic to the point of Latitude 9° 44' 45.90" South, Longitude 143° 23' 36.84" East;
 - (11) thence north-easterly along the geodesic to the point of Latitude 9° 43' 15.96" South, Longitude 143° 26' 33.90" East;
 - (12) thence easterly along that meridian to the point of commencement where it terminates.

DUGONG ISLAND

That area of waters bounded by a line:

- (1) commencing at the point of intersection of the parallel of Latitude 10°30'19.62" South and the meridian of Longitude 143°04'27.78" East;
- (2) running thence east along the geodesic to the point of Latitude 10°30'19.08" South, Longitude 143°05'48.54" East;
- (3) thence south-easterly along the geodesic to the point of Latitude 10°30'36.00" South, Longitude 143°06'44.16" East;
- (4) thence south-easterly along the geodesic to the point of Latitude 10°31'05.88" South, Longitude 143°07'22.92" East;
- (5) thence south along the geodesic to the point of Latitude 10°31'55.38" South, Longitude 143°07'25.56" East;
- (6) thence south-westerly along the geodesic to the point of Latitude 10°32'30.66" South, Longitude 143°07'04.86" East;
- (7) thence south-westerly along the geodesic to the point of Latitude 10°32'37.68" South, Longitude 143°06'14.64" East; and
- (8) thence north-westerly along the geodesic to the point of Latitude 10°31'26.94" South, Longitude 143°03'56.64" East;
- (9) thence north-easterly along that meridian to the point of commencement where it terminates.

COCONUT ISLAND

That area of waters bounded by a line:

- (1) commencing at the point of intersection of the parallel of Latitude 10°02'24.18" South and the meridian of Longitude 143°04'00.72" East;
 - (2) running thence south-easterly along the geodesic to the point of Latitude 10°02'25.98" South, Longitude 143°04'29.46" East;
 - (3) thence south-easterly along the geodesic to the point of Latitude 10°02'40.14" South, Longitude 143°06'01.08" East;
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- (4) thence east along the geodesic to the point of Latitude 10°02'27.12" South, Longitude 143°07'11.46" East;
 - (5) thence south-easterly along the geodesic to the point of Latitude 10°02'43.50" South, Longitude 143°07'53.46" East;
 - (6) thence south-easterly along the geodesic to the point of Latitude 10°03'38.46" South, Longitude 143°08'10.32" East;
 - (7) thence south-westerly along the geodesic to the point of Latitude 10°04'20.88" South, Longitude 143°06'36.48" East;
 - (8) thence west along the geodesic to the point of Latitude 10°04'26.82" South, Longitude 143°04'33.72" East;
 - (9) thence north-westerly along the geodesic to the point of Latitude 10°03'20.88" South, Longitude 143°02'43.02" East;
 - (10) thence north-easterly along the geodesic to the point of Latitude 10°02'31.92" South, Longitude 143°03'29.94" East;
 - (11) thence north-easterly along that meridian to the point of commencement where it terminates.

Schedule 3—Otter trawl equipment

Net length specifications

- (1) where only one net is used or in possession on board a boat or attached to a boat, the length of the net is 88 metres or shorter; or
- (2) where more than one net, including a try-net, is rigged for fishing, the total combined length of the nets is 88 metres or shorter; and
- (3) where more than one net is rigged for fishing, and a try-net is in possession on board the boat but not rigged for fishing, the total combined length of the nets rigged for fishing and the largest try-net in possession on board the boat is 88 metres or shorter; and
- (4) where a try-net is rigged for fishing, in possession on board a boat, or is attached to a boat, the try-net is 10 metres or shorter in length; and
- (5) where other nets, excluding try-nets, are in possession on board a boat and are not rigged for fishing, the nets are of a size that is 10%, or more than 10%, smaller than the largest net on board the boat.

Mesh size specifications

- (1) the size of the meshes in the cod end is 38 millimetres or more; or
- (2) there are 150 meshes or less when measured in the vertical plane from the drawstring; or
- (3) the size of the meshes in all other parts of the net other than the cod end is 45 millimetres or less; or
- (4) there is no more than 1 line of ground chain across the mouth of each net; or
- (5) the diameter of the links of the ground chain are 10 millimetres or less; or
- (6) the chain is not used with a weight or an attachment, other than an attachment for joining the chain to the net.

For the purposes of this Schedule:

- (1) a net is rigged for fishing if part or all of the net is in the water, or if it is shackled, tied or otherwise connected to any trawl door or trawl board, or to any tow rope or cable, either on board the boat or attached in any manner to the boat.
- (2) the length of a net is determined by measuring the combined length, in metres, of the head rope and bottom rope when taut between the outermost points of the meshes that are attached to each rope respectively; and
- (3) the size of a mesh of a knotless trawl net is determined by measuring the average distance when the net is taut, between the inner edges of 2 diagonally opposite corners of each of 10 meshes that are at least 30 centimetres from each other; or

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- (4) knotted trawl net is determined by measuring the average distance when the net is taut, between the inner edges of 2 diagonally opposite knots of each of 10 meshes that are at least 30 centimetres from each other.

Schedule 4—Repeals

Torres Strait Fisheries Management Instrument No. 10

1 The whole of the instrument

Repeal the instrument.

Torres Strait Fisheries Management Instrument No. 11

2 The whole of the instrument

Repeal the instrument.

Torres Strait Fisheries Management Instrument No. 2

3 The whole of the instrument

Repeal the instrument.

Torres Strait Fisheries Management Instrument No. 4

4 The whole of the instrument

Repeal the instrument.

Torres Strait Fisheries Management Instrument No. 17

5 The whole of the instrument

Repeal the instrument.

Schedule 5 – Repeals

Torres Strait Fisheries (Torres Strait Prawn Fishery Total Allowable Effort) Determination 2020

1 The whole of the instrument

Repeal the instrument.